

Does Hype Sell Games? The Metroid Case

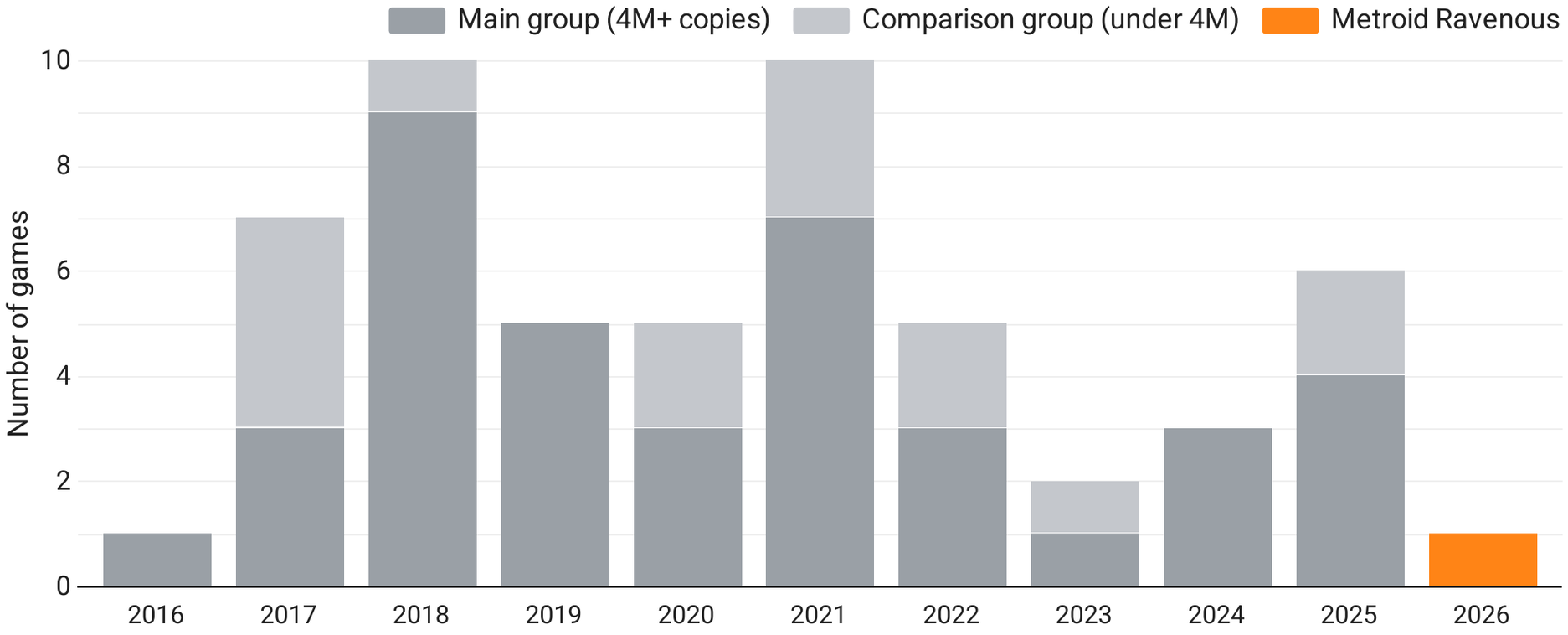
How much pre-launch hype turns into sales,
and what it means for Metroid Ravenous



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Data Analytics Final Project · WBS Coding School
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55 Nintendo games, three data sources

Games by the year their title was revealed. A random group of games under 4M copies keeps the sample from being only hits.



Games in the sample
55

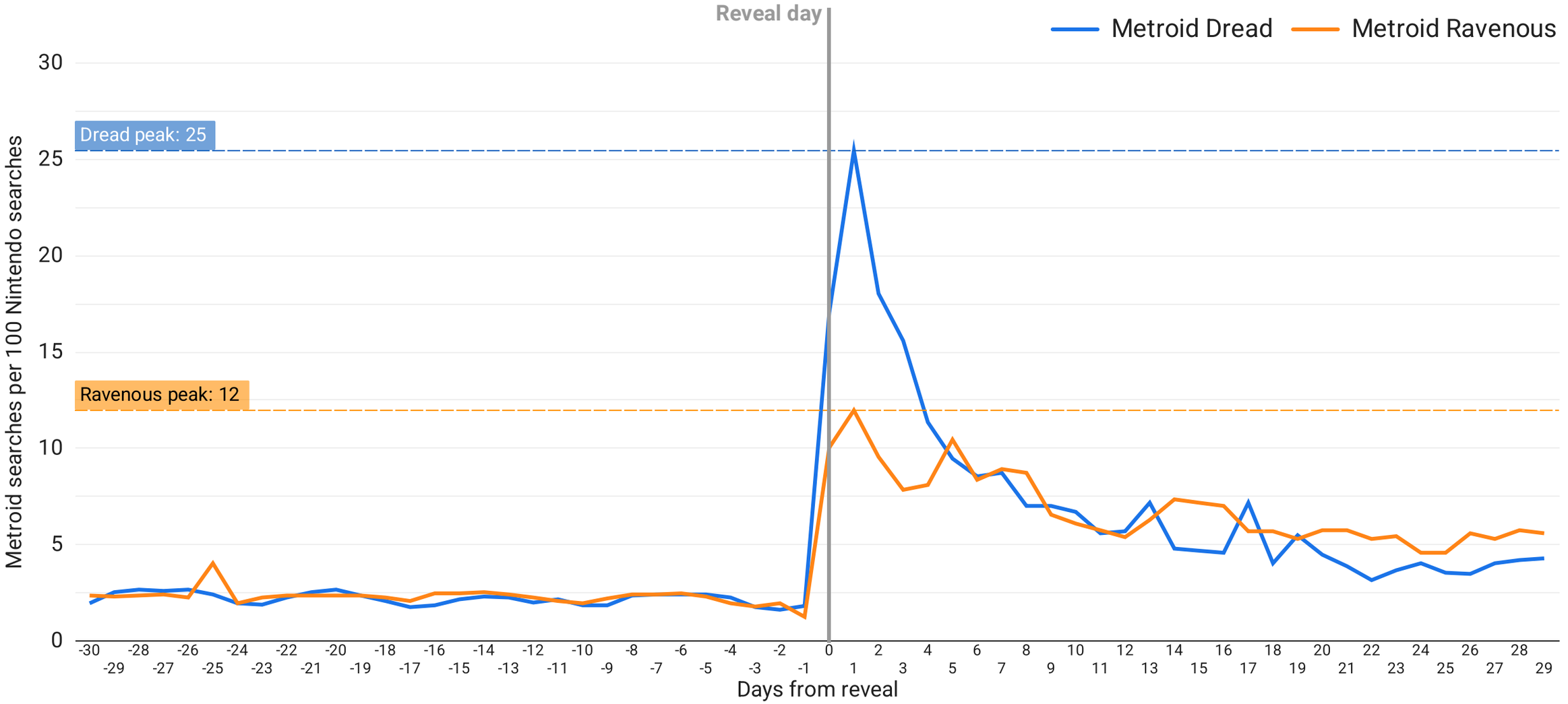
Copies sold (millions)
650



Official Nintendo sales figures + Daily searches (pytrends) + Trailer views, likes and comments → Notebook, coding, analysis → Data warehouse → Dashboard and presentation

Hype has two parts

Before the reveal, the line shows fans who were already searching. After it, the jump shows the reveal buzz.



Same starting point (about 2 per 100). Dread jumped higher (25); Ravenous stayed higher for longer (5 vs 4 a month later).

Dread had the biggest jump, yet 33 of 40 games sold more

Top 10 of 40 Nintendo games by how much searches jumped after the reveal, with their sales.

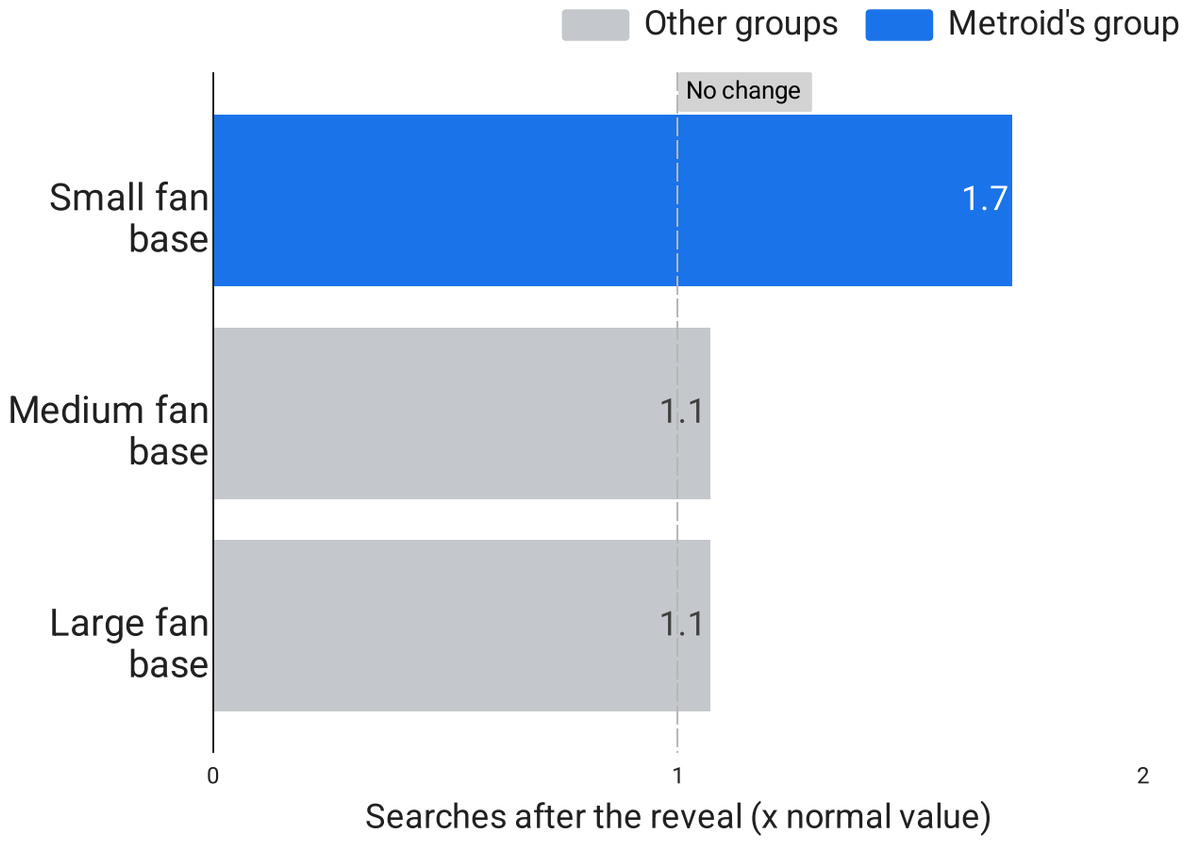
Game	Search jump after the reveal (×)	Copies sold (millions)
Metroid Dread	4.4	3.07
Pokkén Tournament DX	3.3	1.54
Paper Mario: Origami King	2.9	3.47
Bayonetta	2.4	1.24
Bayonetta 3	2.4	1.07
Super Smash Bros. Ultimate	2.4	38.14
Super Mario 3D World + Bowser's Fury	1.9	13.47
Mario Kart World	1.9	15.39
Super Mario Party	1.9	21.36
Splatoon 3	1.7	11.96

Bayonetta and Bayonetta 3 were announced together, so they share one measurement.

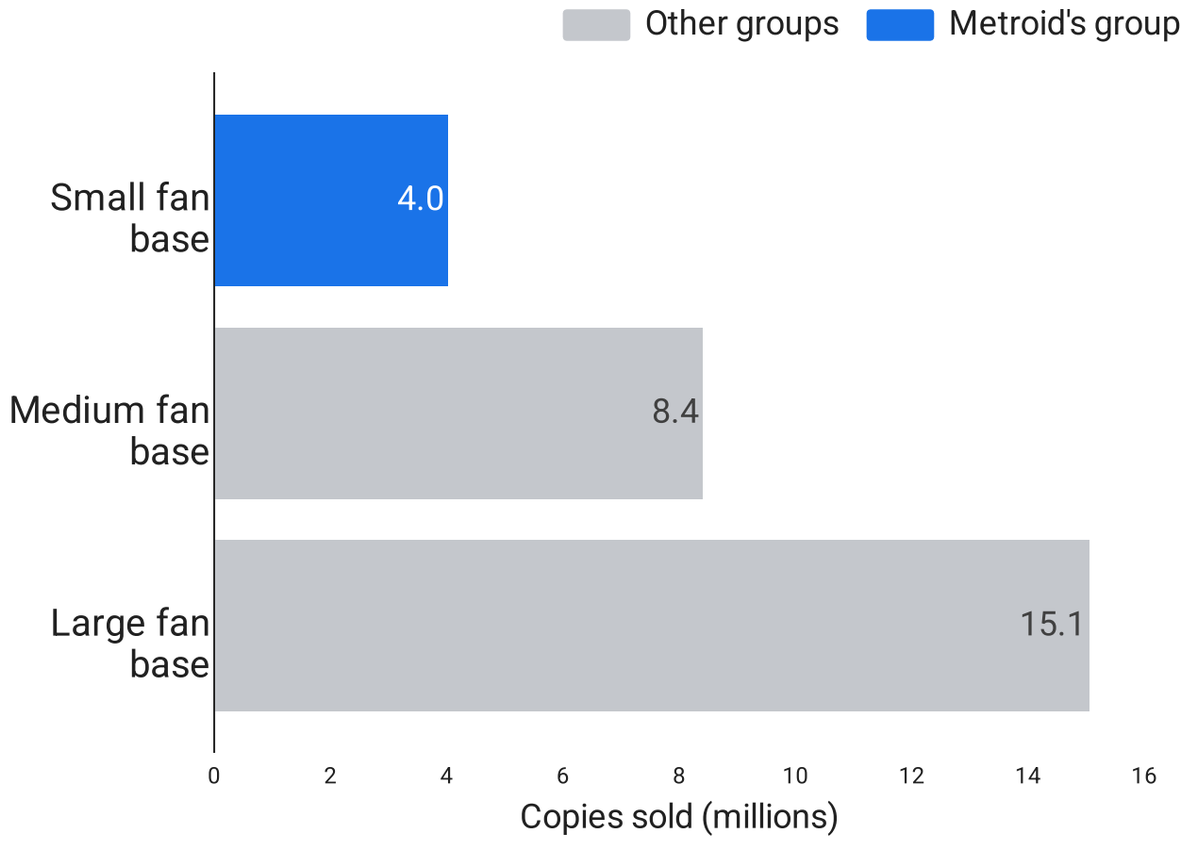
Small fan bases jump most, big fan bases sell most

The bigger the fan base before the reveal, the smaller the jump after it, but the higher the sales.

How much searches jumped after the reveal



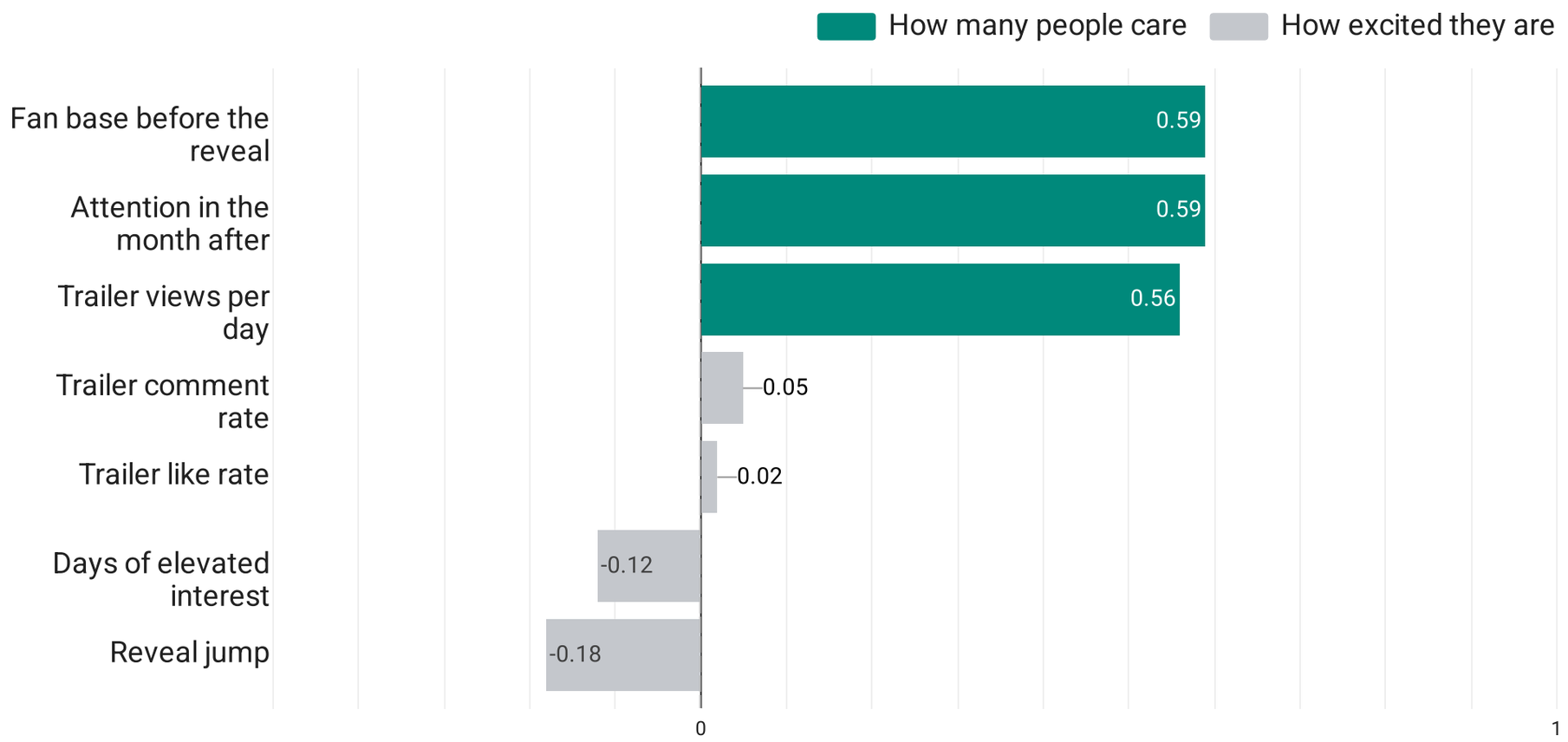
How many copies they sold



40 Nintendo games split into three equal groups by fan base size. Each bar shows the middle game of its group (median). Metroid Dread is in the small group.

How many people care goes with sales, how excited they are doesn’t

How strongly each hype signal goes with copies sold (rank correlation, controlling for time on sale). 0 = no link.



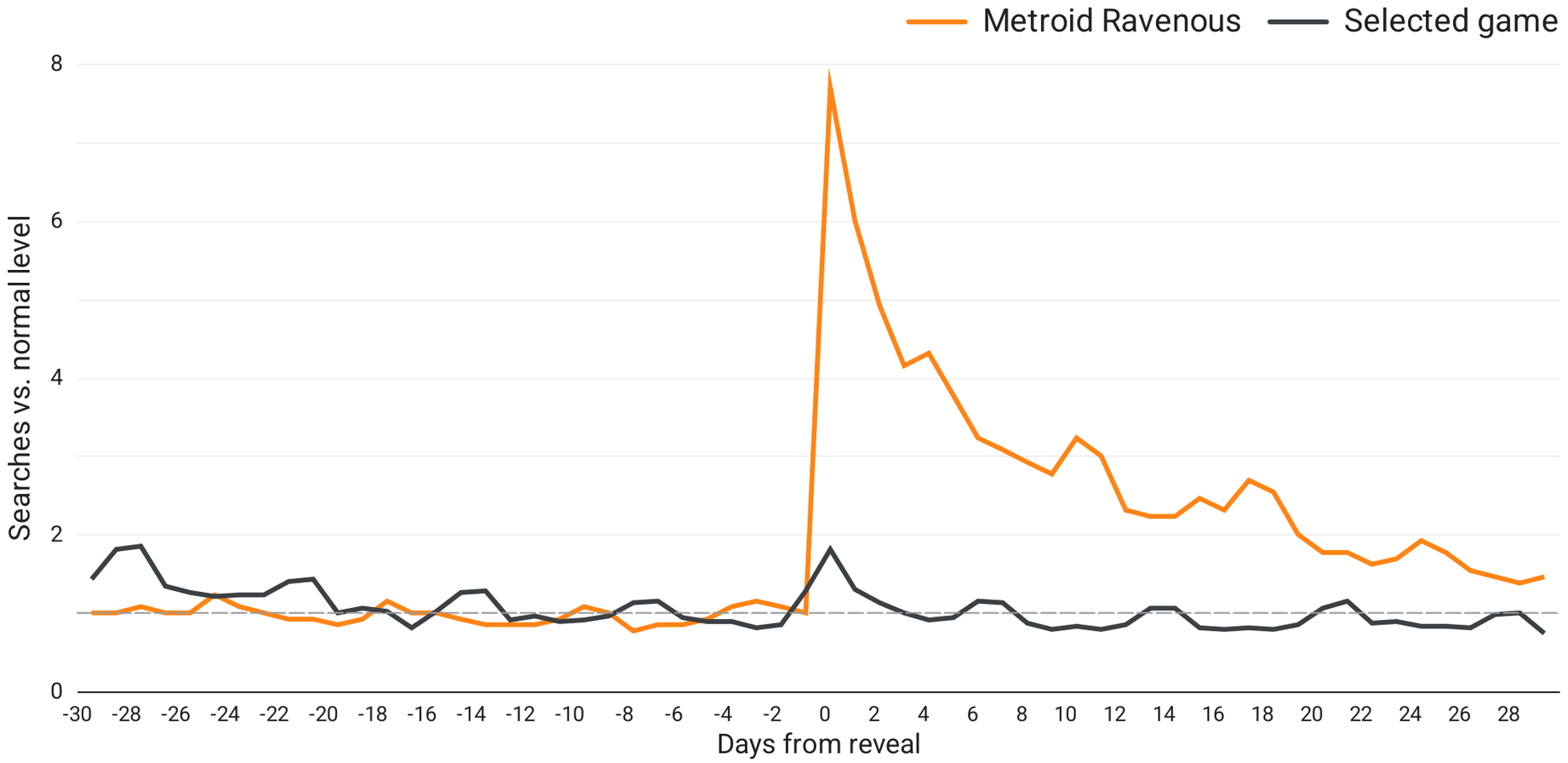
40 games (26 to 33 for YouTube signals). The three turquoise signals have a clear link: their 95% range stays above zero.

Pick any game and compare it with Ravenous

Each line shows daily searches compared with the game's own normal level before the reveal (1 = normal).

Choose a game to compare: Pokémon Scarlet and Violet (1)

Only the 40 games with enough search data to measure reliably. 14 games were excluded, mostly new or generic titles with no searches before their reveal.



Fan base (searches per 100 Nintendo)
246

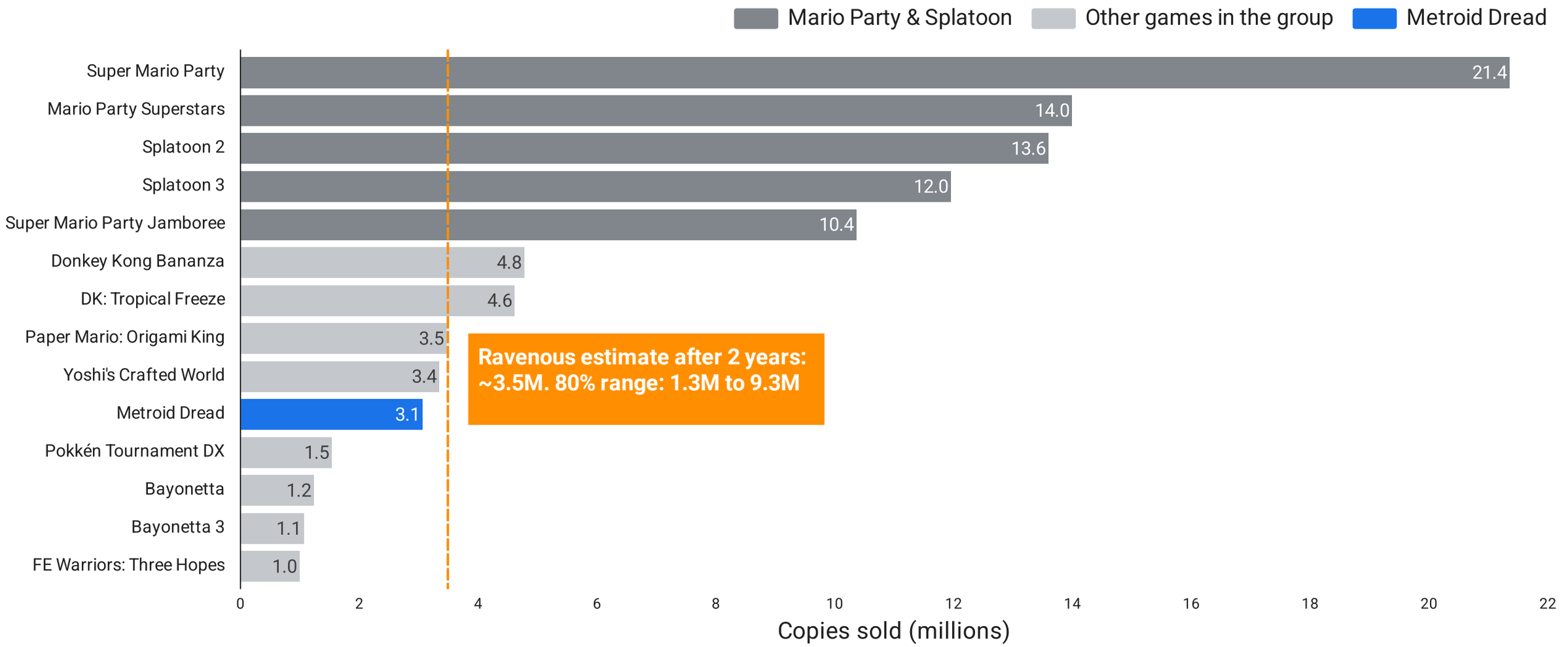
Average jump after the reveal (×)
1.0

Copies sold (millions)
28.5

Metroid Ravenous:
fan base 2.4 · jump 2.8×
not released yet

Ravenous could sell about 3.5M copies in two years

Model of 40 games: about 2.7M after one year and 3.5M after two. Dread sold 3.1M in its first 15 months.



These are the 14 games with a small fan base, like Metroid. The 3.5M is an estimate, not a promise. Sales are the latest official figures, measured at different times after release. The five games above 10M are all Mario Party or Splatoon.

Hype tells you how excited fans are, not how many there are



What I found

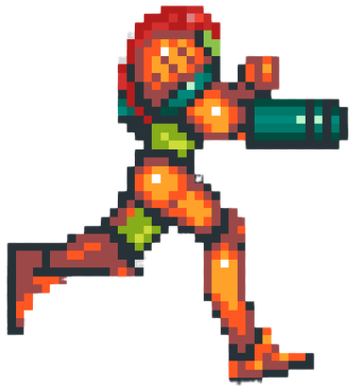
The size of the existing fan base goes with sales **(0.59)**.
The reveal jump doesn't **(−0.18)**.
A big reaction only shows a small franchise woke up.

What it means for Ravenous

About 3.5M copies in two years, close to Dread.
To sell more, Metroid needs more fans, not a louder reveal.

Who can use this

Marketing and product teams: read reveal buzz as excitement, not as a sales forecast, and track fan base growth between launches.



Limits and next steps

Correlation, not causation · 40 Nintendo games only · Only the first month after each reveal · Google Trends shows relative interest, not real search counts · Prices and bundles not included.

Next: compare with Ravenous's real sales after launch, and analyze trailer comments to learn what players want.



Thanks for your attention!



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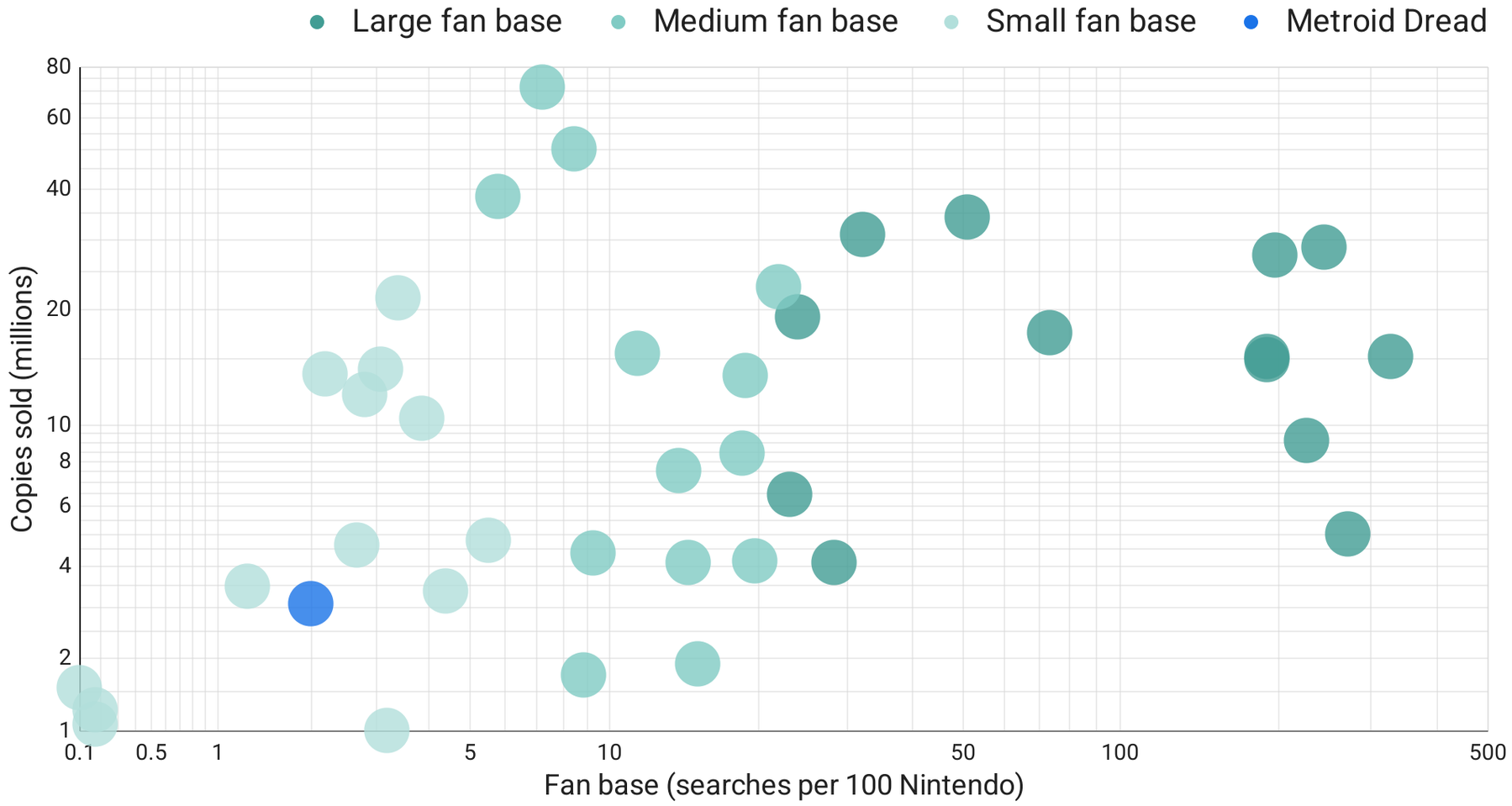
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For analysts: the evidence

Games with bigger fan bases tend to sell more. Metroid Dread (blue) has a small fan base.

Sample group

Platform



Games with a fan base of 0 are plotted at 0.1.

For analysts: the numbers

Signals of how many people care predict sales, signals of how excited they are don't. A simple model puts Ravenous at about 3.5M copies after two years.

Signal	Type	Correlation ▾	CI low	CI high	Games
Fan base before the reveal	How many people care	0.59	0.30	0.77	40
Attention in the month after	How many people care	0.59	0.34	0.76	40
Trailer views per day	How many people care	0.56	0.23	0.76	33
Trailer comment rate	How excited they are	0.05	-0.38	0.45	26
Trailer like rate	How excited they are	0.02	-0.42	0.38	33
Days of elevated interest	How excited they are	-0.12	-0.46	0.26	40
Reveal jump	How excited they are	-0.18	-0.49	0.21	40

Partial Spearman correlation with copies sold, controlling for time on sale. Intervals: 95% bootstrap (2,000 resamples). Turquoise = the interval stays above 0.

Regression (OLS, n = 40)

log(copies sold) ~ log(1 + fan base) + years on sale

- **Fan base**: +0.33 ($p < 0.001$). Doubling the fan base ≈ +26% copies.
- **Years on sale**: +0.26 ($p < 0.001$). Each extra year ≈ +30% copies.
- **Reveal jump**: no clear effect ($p = 0.35$).
- **Model fit**: $R^2 = 0.58$. Check: Dread predicted 2.7M, actual 3.07M.
- **Ravenous after 2 years:** **~3.5M** (80% interval 1.3–9.3M).

For analysts: methods and limits

How the data was built, which games were left out, and what this analysis can’t tell you.

Data and sample

- Games: 54 Nintendo games on Switch and Switch 2, plus Metroid Ravenous (no sales yet).
- Main group: 38 games with 4M+ copies, plus Dread.
- Comparison group: 15 games under 4M, so the study doesn't only look at hits.
- Sales: Nintendo figures via Wikipedia, reported at different dates.
- Final sample: 40 games.

How each signal is measured

- Fan base: searches per 100 "Nintendo", 90 days before the reveal.
- Attention after: the same, 30 days after.
- Reveal jump: interest 30 days after ÷ normal level before.
- Days elevated: days out of 30 above normal.
- YouTube: trailer views per day, like and comment rates.
- Time on sale: release date to sales date.

14 games left out

- Too few searches to measure a fan base (10): *1-2-Switch, Big Brain Academy, Clubhouse Games, Game Builder Garage, Hyrule Warriors: Age of Imprisonment, Luigi's Mansion 3, Mario Strikers, Mario Tennis Aces, Miitopia, Ring Fit Adventure*.
- Normal interest too low to measure a jump (4): *Hyrule Warriors: Age of Calamity, Switch Sports, Super Mario RPG, Tomodachi Life*.
- A near-zero normal level inflates the jump: *Super Mario RPG* (14.8×).

Limits

- 40 games: wide intervals, small effects can't be ruled out.
- Correlation, not causation: big franchises also get more marketing.
- Google Trends struggles with new or generic names, and some excluded games sold a lot.
- Only Nintendo games, and YouTube data covers 33 of the 40.
- Same-franchise games are not independent: resampling by franchise widens the intervals, but the result holds.
- The Ravenous range is wide (1.3–9.3M) and ignores the Switch 2 player base and marketing.
- Prices, bundles and discounts not modeled (Mario Kart World was bundled with Switch 2).
- Hype measured only in the month after the reveal, not until launch.